

International Relations Course Offerings and Subfield Requirements

Last updated: December 18, 2025

Core Courses

PLSC 6950a/b. International Security. Noam Reich. Alex Debs.
PLSC 6980a/b. International Political Economy. Didac Queralt.

Elective Courses

PLSC 5330a. Formal Models of International Relations. Alexandre Debs.
PLSC 6650b. The Politics of International Migration: Integration Prospects and Challenges. Nicholas Sambanis.
PLSC 6670a. Domestic Politics in International Relations. Soyoung Lee.
PLSC 6700b. Nationalism and Territorial Conflict. Soyoung Lee.
PLSC 6840a. China's International Relations. Feng Zhang.
PLSC 6850b. Chinese Thinking on International Relations. Feng Zhang.
PLSC 6900b/6910a. Identity and Conflict Lab. Nicholas Sambanis.
PLSC 6970b. Chinese Foreign Policy. Dan Mattingly
PLSC 7320b. The War in Ukraine. David Cameron.
PLSC 7630a/b. State Formation. Didac Queralt.
PLSC 7560a. The European Union. David Cameron.

Workshops

PLSC 9400a/9410b. International Relations Workshop. Varying Instructors.

Note:

-a courses are offered in the Fall, b courses are offered in the Spring. ab courses are offered in the Fall and Spring. a/b courses are offered in the Fall or Spring.

Subfield Requirements

Students may qualify in International Relations either by exam or coursework.

To qualify in IR by exam, students who entered the program before Fall 2026 must first take the two core courses. Other courses are highly recommended. Students who entered the program in or after Fall 2026 must first take the two core courses and one elective.

To qualify in IR by coursework, students must take the two core courses, plus one of the elective courses. Students may take one of those credits via transfer from another institution as approved by the DGS in consultation with the IR field coordinator. (Please note that Grand Strategy, courses in the Global Affairs Master's program, and other non-departmental graduate courses are not acceptable substitutes.) Additionally, students must write an IR-themed paper,

in the context of an IR course, that shows a strong command of the substantive and methodological approaches in the field.